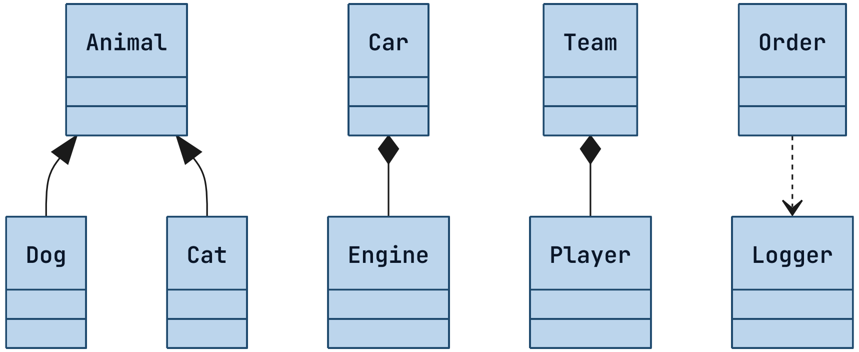
MERMAID CLASS · STATE · ER · C4 · PIE NARRATION

Read-aloud that reads the model.

Read-aloud narrated flowcharts, then the sequence message script. Now it reads the rest of the first wave — the typed-relationship diagrams. Their power is the faithfulness asymmetry: a class arrow, an ER crow's-foot, a C4 `Rel` *all have a **Mermaid-defined** meaning, so speaking that meaning is reading the author's choice, not inventing one (design 2026-07-14, first-wave slice #2).*

01 · CLASSDIAGRAM

The symbol IS the verb.

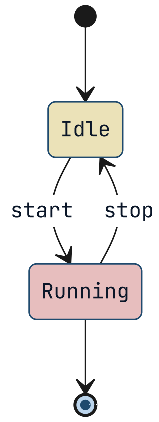


KEY INSIGHT

A flowchart arrow reads a neutral "leads to" because its meaning isn't authored. A class arrow is different: `<|--` is *defined* as inheritance, `*--` as composition, `o--` as aggregation, `..>` as dependency. So the reading speaks the defined verb, in the right direction: "Dog inherits from Animal. Cat inherits from Animal. Car is composed of Engine. Team aggregates Player. Order depends on Logger." A relationship label overrides the verb; a `"1" --> "*"` multiplicity trails as "one to many."

02 · STATEDIAGRAM

Start and end are read from position.

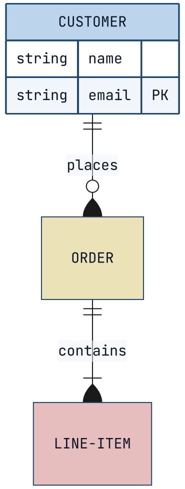


KEY INSIGHT

`[*]` is the start or end by *where it sits* — a source is the entry, a target is the exit. Each transition reads its authored event: "It starts at Idle. From Idle, on start, goes to Running. From Running, on stop, goes to Idle. Running can end." A composite `state X { … }`, a `--` concurrency divider, or a `<<fork>>` bails to the heading — a flat reading would misstate parallel or nested structure.

03 · ERDIAGRAM

Both cardinalities, read literally.

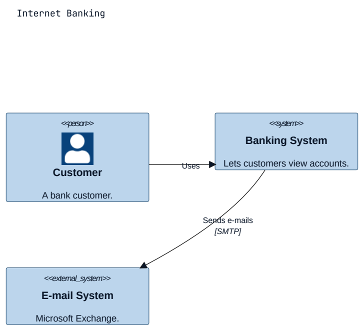


KEY INSIGHT

The crow's-foot counts are Mermaid-defined, so the reading transcribes *both* — never gambling a single direction: "One CUSTOMER places zero or more ORDER. One ORDER contains one or more LINE-ITEM." An attribute block reads its fields and their key roles: "CUSTOMER has attributes name and email as the primary key."

04 · C4

Typed people, systems, and their relationships.

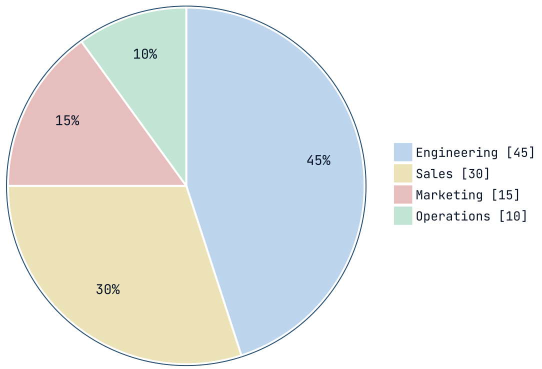


KEY INSIGHT

Each element reads its kind and description: "Customer, a person: A bank customer. Banking System, a system: Lets customers view accounts. E-mail System, an external system: Microsoft Exchange." — "external" is spoken only on an `_Ext` element. A `Rel` reads its authored label and direction, honoring `Rel_Back` and ignoring the `_U/_D/_L/_R` layout hints: "Customer Uses Banking System. Banking System Sends e-mails E-mail System, over SMTP."

05 · PIE

The percentage, derived the way Mermaid derives it.

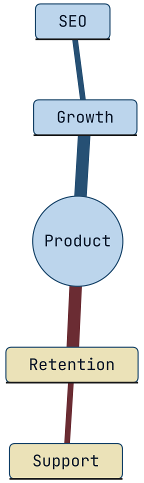


KEY INSIGHT

A pie chart's share is a value Mermaid itself computes and shows, so speaking it is faithful, not invented: "A pie chart, Where the budget goes. Engineering, forty-five, forty-five percent. Sales, thirty, thirty percent. Marketing, fifteen, fifteen percent. Operations, ten, ten percent." (`showData` speaks the raw value alongside the share.) A chart with fewer than two slices, or a non-positive total, bails.

06 · HONEST BAIL

What isn't in the first wave reads its heading.



KEY INSIGHT

mindmap, gantt, timeline, journey, quadrant, and the rest fall back to the slide's heading and this caption for now — exactly as before. Each graduates in its own later slice, under the same rule: read the author's defined meaning faithfully, or say nothing.

The model is spoken now.

class · state · ER · C4 · pie · every defined symbol read as the author's verb